



Alternating Characters

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You are given a string containing characters **A** and **B** only. Your task is to change it into a string such that there are no matching adjacent characters. To do this, you are allowed to delete zero or more characters in the string.

Your task is to find the minimum number of required deletions.

Example**s** = **AABBAAB**

Remove an **A** at positions **0** and **3** to make **s** = **ABAB** in **2** deletions.

Function Description

Complete the alternatingCharacters function in the editor below.

alternatingCharacters has the following parameter(s):

- string s: a string

Returns

- int: the minimum number of deletions required

Input Format

The first line contains an integer **q**, the number of queries.

The next **q** lines each contain a string **s** to analyze.

Constraints

- $1 \leq q \leq 10$
- $1 \leq \text{length of } s \leq 10^5$
- Each string **s** will consist only of characters **A** and **B**.

Sample Input

```
5
AAAA
BBBB
ABABAB
BABABA
AABBB
```

Sample Output

```
3
4
-
```

Author [amitkgp](#)
Difficulty [Easy](#)
Max Score [20](#)
Submitted By [342335](#)

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Change Theme Language Java 15

```
1 import java.util.*;
2
3 public class Solution {
4
5     public static int alternatingCharacters(String s) {
6         int deletions = 0;
7
8         for (int i = 1; i < s.length(); i++) {
9             if (s.charAt(i) == s.charAt(i - 1)) {
10                 deletions++;
11             }
12         }
13
14         return deletions;
15     }
16
17     public static void main(String[] args) {
18         Scanner sc = new Scanner(System.in);
19
20         int q = sc.nextInt();
21
22         while (q-- > 0) {
23             String s = sc.next();
24             System.out.println(alternatingCharacters(s));
25         }
26
27         sc.close();
28     }
29 }
```

Line: 29 Col: 2

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Run Code

Submit Code



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33%

63.33/100

Congratulations

You solved this challenge. Would you like to challenge your friends?  

Next Challenge

✓ Test case 0

✓ Test case 1 

✓ Test case 2 

✓ Test case 3 

✓ Test case 4 

✓ Test case 5 

✓ Test case 6 

Compiler Message

Success

Input (stdin)

```
1 5
2 AAAA
3 BBBBB
4 ABABABAB
5 BABABA
6 AAABBB
```

Expected Output

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